**Stay Safe Online**

Navigating college life in India means being constantly connected—from attending online classes and joining campus WhatsApp groups to paying for services with UPI. Use this checklist to protect your digital identity and personal finances.

**1. Master Your UPI Hygiene**

- **The "Receiving" Rule:** Remember that you never need to enter your UPI PIN to receive money. If someone asks you to scan a QR code or enter a PIN to get a "scholarship refund" or "prize," it is a scam.
- **Verify Recipient Details:** Before hitting 'Pay' on apps like GPay, PhonePe, or Paytm, double-check the verified name of the recipient to avoid sending funds to spoofed accounts.

**2. Lock Down Your SIM Card**

- **SIM Swap Protection:** Your SIM card is the primary key to your bank OTPs. If your mobile signal disappears for an extended period without explanation, contact your service provider immediately.
- **Set a SIM PIN:** Enable a SIM PIN in your phone's security settings to prevent unauthorized use of your number if the physical device is stolen.

**3. Secure Your Social Identity**

- **Privacy Settings:** Set your social media profiles to 'Private'. Be cautious of "Follow Requests" from accounts with no mutual friends or those that appear to mimic your classmates.
- **Protect PII:** Avoid posting photos of your college identity cards, hostel room details, or digital admit cards that contain Personally Identifiable Information (PII).

**4. Beware of "Digital Arrest" Scams**

- **Identify the Scam:** If you receive a call from individuals claiming to be from the CBI, Mumbai Police, or Narcotics Bureau alleging you are under "Digital Arrest" via video call, hang up immediately.

**Official Protocol:** Indian law enforcement agencies do not conduct investigations or arrests through Skype or WhatsApp video calls.

**5. Campus Wi-Fi Precautions**

- **Avoid Public Logins:** Do not access net banking or enter sensitive credit card details while connected to campus or public Wi-Fi networks.
- **Use Encryption:** If you must use shared networks, utilize a reputable VPN service to encrypt your internet traffic.

**6. Vet Every App Before Installing**

- **Official Sources:** Only download applications from the Google Play Store or Apple App Store. Avoid "modded" versions of popular apps which may contain hidden spyware.
- **Permissions Review:** If a utility application asks for excessive permissions (like access to your microphone or contacts) without a logical reason, uninstall it.

**7. Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)**

- **Security Layers:** Enable 2FA on your college email and messaging apps. Prefer using an authenticator app over SMS-based codes where possible.

**8. Use Strong, Unique Passwords**

- **Avoid Predictability:** Do not use your name, birth year, or simple college-related strings as passwords. Use a password manager to maintain unique credentials for every service.

**IF YOU ARE TARGETED: REPORT IT!**

- Call the National Cyber Crime Helpline at **1930**
- Lodge a formal complaint at **www.cybercrime.gov.in**
- Notify your bank within 24 hours for any financial fraud cases.